Dear Quillstone Payments AI Team,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role. My experience building applied machine-learning workflows for forecasting and customer retention has given me a practical foundation in Python, feature engineering, model evaluation and operational delivery. I am keen to bring that experience to systems that help merchants and support teams get useful answers quickly.

At Thistlebox, I built a weekly recipe-demand forecasting workflow using LightGBM, with engineered calendar, price and menu-position features. It runs as a scheduled Vertex AI Workbench notebook, writes forecasts to BigQuery, and makes them available to operations through Looker; forecast WAPE improved from 23% to 14%. I also developed an XGBoost churn model whose weekly BigQuery scoring supported targeted retention offers, with a 10% holdout evaluation reporting a 2.1 percentage-point reduction in churn in the treated group.

I have also built a Streamlit application for planning and analysing sequential A/B tests, used by around 25 people in product and growth, and authored its Dockerfile. In my current work, I write pytest unit tests for forecasting feature-engineering code, with coverage now around 60%. These projects have strengthened my ability to develop and evaluate practical ML workflows and work with product, operations and data-platform colleagues. I would welcome the opportunity to build on that experience within Quillstone's customer-support AI team and its pragmatic, collaborative learning culture.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience could contribute to the team.

Kind regards,
Tobias Mwangi-Hartley